



EGGLESS PUMPKIN DOUBLE-CHOCOLATE CUPCAKES

with Pumpkin-Spice Buttercream • Gourmet Halloween Edition

1. EGGLESS DOUBLE-CHOCOLATE PUMPKIN CUPCAKES

Ingredient	Weight
Plain flour	180 g
Dutch-process cocoa powder	35 g
Cornflour	15 g
Baking powder	4 g
Baking soda	2 g
Fine sea salt	2 g
Ground cinnamon	2 g
Ground ginger	1 g
Ground nutmeg	0.5 g
Ground cloves	0.2 g
100% pumpkin purée	220 g
Full-fat Greek yoghurt	100 g
Full-fat milk	80 g
Neutral oil	65 g
Unsalted butter, melted	45 g
Caster sugar	125 g
Dark brown sugar	65 g
Vanilla bean paste	5 g
Espresso powder	2 g
70% dark couverture, melted	90 g
Dark chocolate, chopped	100 g

Method

- Pumpkin:** If the purée is watery, cook gently for 3–5 minutes until thick and spoonable. Cool.
- Chocolate:** Melt the 70% couverture gently to 40–45°C.
- Dry mix:** Sift flour, cocoa, cornflour, baking powder, baking soda, salt and all four pumpkin spices.
- Wet mix:** Whisk pumpkin, yoghurt, milk, oil, melted butter, both sugars, vanilla and espresso until smooth.
- Chocolate:** Whisk in the melted couverture until homogeneous.
- Combine:** Fold in the dry ingredients in two additions, stopping as soon as combined.
- Chocolate chips:** Fold through the chopped dark chocolate.
- Portion:** Divide into 12 liners, about two-thirds full.

9. **Bake:** 170°C conventional / 160°C fan for about 17–21 minutes. Look for moist crumbs, not a clean skewer.

10. **Cool:** Rest 5 minutes in the tray, then cool completely on a rack.

2. PUMPKIN-SPICE BUTTERCREAM

Ingredient	Weight
Unsalted butter, softened	150 g
Icing sugar, sifted	75 g
Full-fat milk powder	15 g
Thick pumpkin purée	35 g
Vanilla bean paste	2 g
Ground cinnamon	1 g
Ground ginger	0.5 g
Ground nutmeg	0.2 g
Fine sea salt	0.5 g

Method

1. Beat softened butter for 4–5 minutes until pale and fluffy.
2. Add icing sugar, milk powder and salt; beat until smooth.
3. Add pumpkin purée, vanilla, cinnamon, ginger and nutmeg; beat until silky and pipeable.
4. If soft, chill 10–15 minutes and re-whip briefly.

3. ASSEMBLY & FINISH

Optional centre: Core each cooled cupcake and fill with 8–10 g pumpkin-spice buttercream.

Pipe: Use a large open-star nozzle and pipe one generous swirl.

Finish: Sprinkle a small amount of dark chocolate chips over the buttercream. Keep the garnish restrained.

Halloween presentation: Serve beside a real carved pumpkin with a small warm light inside for a refined seasonal presentation.

4. PROFESSIONAL NOTES

- Use thick, unsweetened 100% pumpkin purée; excess water makes the crumb heavy.
- Good-quality couverture gives a deeper chocolate flavour.
- The pumpkin spice should be warm and noticeable without overpowering the chocolate.
- Once flour is added, avoid overmixing.
- Cool cupcakes completely before piping.
- Store airtight and refrigerated; bring towards room temperature before serving.

Target result: Deeply chocolatey, moist and soft eggless cupcakes with warm pumpkin-spice notes, dark chocolate pieces and smooth pumpkin-spice buttercream.

THE CURLY CHEF • EGGLESS PÂTISSERIE